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**PRIORITIZATION,
DELEGATION
AND MANAGEMENT OF
CARE QUESTIONS FOR
THE NCLEX EXAM**

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Cardiovascular Management QUESTIONS

31. The wife of a client calls the clinic and tells the nurse her husband is having chest pain but won't go to the hospital. Which action should the nurse implement first?

1. Instruct the wife to call 911 immediately.
2. Tell the wife to have the client chew an aspirin.
3. Ask the wife what the client had to eat recently.
4. Request the husband talk to the clinic nurse.

32. The home health (HH) nurse received phone messages from the agency secretary. Which client should the nurse phone first?

1. The client diagnosed with hypertension who is reporting a BP of 148/92.
2. The client diagnosed with cardiomyopathy who has a pulse oximeter reading of 93%.
3. The client diagnosed with congestive heart failure who has edematous feet.
4. The client diagnosed with chronic atrial fibrillation who is having chest pain.

33. The client is diagnosed with end-stage congestive heart failure. The nurse finds the client lying in bed, short of breath, unable to talk, and with buccal cyanosis. Which intervention should the nurse implement first?

1. Assist the client to a sitting position.
2. Assess the client's vital signs.
3. Call 911 for the paramedics.
4. Auscultate the client's lung sounds.

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34. The home health (HH) nurse is visiting a client diagnosed with congestive heart Failure. The client has an out-of-hospital do not resuscitate (DNR) order, has stopped Breathing, and has no pulse or blood pressure. The client's family is at the bedside. Which intervention should the HH nurse implement first?

1. Contact the agency's chaplain.
2. Pronounce the client's death.
3. Ask the family to leave the bedside.
4. Call the client's funeral home.

35. The cardiac nurse received laboratory results on the following clients. Which client warrants immediate intervention from the nurse?

1. The client who has an INR of 2.8.
2. The client who has a serum potassium level of 3.8 mEq/L.
3. The client who has a serum digoxin level of 2.6 mg/dL.
4. The client who has a glycosylated hemoglobin of 6%.

36. The home health (HH) nurse is completing the admission assessment for an obese client diagnosed with a myocardial infarction with comorbid type 1 diabetes and arterial hypertension. Which priority intervention should the nurse implement?

1. Encourage the client to walk 30 minutes a day.
2. Request an HH-registered dietician to talk to the client.
3. Refer the client to a cardiac rehabilitation unit.
4. Discuss the client's need to lose 1 to 2 pounds a week.

37. The home health (HH) nurse is preparing for the initial visit to a client diagnosed with congestive heart failure. Which intervention should the HH nurse implement first?

1. Prepare all the needed equipment for the visit.
2. Call the client to arrange a time for the visit.
3. Review the client's referral form/pertinent data.
4. Make the necessary referrals for the client.

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38. Which information should the experienced home health (HH) nurse discuss when orienting a new nurse to HH nursing?

1. If the client or family is hostile or obnoxious, call the police.
2. Carry the HH care agency identification in a purse or wallet.
3. Visits can be scheduled at night with permission from the agency.
4. Inform the agency of the times of the client's scheduled visits.

39. The home health (HH) aide tells the HH nurse that the grandson of the client she is caring for asked her out on a date. Which statement is the HH nurse's best response?

1. "I am so excited for you; he seems like a very nice young man."
2. "You should not go out with him as long as she is a client of our agency."
3. "I think you should tell the director of the HH care agency about this date."
4. "You should never date someone you meet while taking care of a client."

40. The cardiac nurse is teaching the client diagnosed with congestive heart failure. Which teaching interventions should the nurse discuss with the client? Select all that apply.

1. Notify the healthcare provider (HCP) if the client gains more than 2 lb in one day.
2. Keep the head of the bed elevated when sleeping.
3. Take the loop diuretic once a day before going to sleep.
4. Teach the client which foods are high in sodium and should be avoided.
5. Perform isotonic exercises at least once a day.

41. The nurse is administering medications on a cardiac unit. Which medication should the nurse question administering?

1. Warfarin (Coumadin), an anticoagulant, to a client with a prothrombin time (PT) of 14 and an International Normalized Ratio (INR) of 1.6 mg/dL.
2. Digoxin (Lanoxin), a cardiac glycoside, to a client with a potassium level of 3.3 mEq/L.
3. Atenolol (Tenormin), a beta-blocker, for the client with an aspartate aminotransferase (AST) of 18 U/L.
4. Lisinopril (Zestril), an ACE-inhibitor, for the client with a serum creatinine level of 0.8 mg/dL.

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42. The nurse is providing end-of-life care to the client diagnosed with cardiomyopathy who is in hospice. Which priority assessment intervention should the nurse implement?

1. Assess the client's spiritual needs.
2. Assess the client's financial situation.
3. Assess the client's support system.
4. Assess the client's medical diagnosis.

43. The husband of the client diagnosed with infective endocarditis and who has a do not resuscitate (DNR) tells the nurse, "My wife is not breathing." Which intervention should the nurse implement first?

1. Contact the client's healthcare provider (HCP).
2. Notify the Rapid Response Team.
3. Stay with the client and her husband.
4. Instruct the UAP to perform post-mortem care.

44. The hospice nurse is triaging phone calls from clients. Which client should the nurse call first?

1. The client whose family reports the client is not eating.
2. The client who wants to rescind the out-of-hospital DNR.
3. The client whose pain is not being controlled with the current medications.
4. The client whose urinary incontinence has caused a Stage 1 pressure ulcer.

45. The hospice nurse is working with a volunteer. Which task could the nurse delegate to the volunteer?

1. Sit with the client while he or she reminisces about life experiences.
2. Give the client a sponge bath and rub lotion on the bony prominences.
3. Provide spiritual support for the client and family members.
4. Check the home to see that all necessary medical equipment is available.

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ANSWERS AND RATIONALE

31.

Answer is 2. The AHA recommends the client having chest pain chew an aspirin to help decrease platelet aggregation. This is the first intervention the clinic nurse should tell the wife to do. The client is in distress; therefore, the nurse should have the wife do something.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker should apply the nursing process when the question asks the nurse, "Which intervention should be implemented first?" If the client is in distress, do not assess; if the client is in distress, do something.

32

Answer is 4. The client with chronic atrial fibrillation is at risk for pulmonary emboli, a potentially life-threatening complication. Chest pain is a common symptom of pulmonary embolism. The nurse should contact this client first.

33

Answer 1. The nurse's first intervention is to assist the client to a sitting position to decrease the workload of the heart by decreasing venous return and maximizing lung expansion. This will, it is hoped, help relieve the client's respiratory distress.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The nurse should remember that if a client is in distress and the nurse can do something to relieve the distress, that action should be done first, before assessment. The test taker should select an option that directly helps the client's condition.

34

Answer is 2. Nurses in home health have been given the authority to pronounce death for clients who are on service and death is imminent. This intervention should be implemented first.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The NCLEX-RN® blueprint includes nursing care that is ruled by legal requirements. The nurse must be knowledgeable of these issues. The nurse must be aware of the rules and regulations of the various areas of nursing.

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35

Answer is 3. The client's digoxin level is higher than the therapeutic level for digoxin, which is 0.8 to 2 mg/dL. This client should be contacted first to assess for signs/ symptoms of digoxin toxicity

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker must know normal laboratory data.

36

Answer 3. Cardiac rehabilitation includes progressive exercise, diet teaching, and classes on modifying risk factors. This supervised setting would be the priority intervention for this client when the client is discharged from HH.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker must be knowledgeable of the role of each member of the multidisciplinary healthcare team as well as HIPAA rules and regulations. These topics will be tested on the NCLEX-RN® exam.

37

Answer is 3. The nurse should review the client's referral form and other pertinent data concerning the client's condition first before taking any further steps. The nurse may need to contact the referring agency if the information is unclear or if important information is missing. This is assessment.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: Assessment is the first step of the nursing process, and the test taker should use the nursing process or some other systematic process to assist in determining priorities. The client is not in distress because he/she is at home.

38

Answer is 4. The agency should be informed of the schedule so the nurse can be located if the nurse does not return when expected.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker must be knowledgeable of all the various areas of nursing and the role of each member of the multidisciplinary healthcare team, as well as HIPAA rules and regulations. These topics will be tested on the NCLEX-RN® exam.

39

Answer is 2. This statement protects the HH aide. This is professional boundary crossing. The employee should not date any relatives of the client because this may pose a conflict of interest. The HH aide should wait until the client is no longer on service.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: There will be management questions on the NCLEX-RN®. In many instances, there is no test-taking strategy; the nurse must be knowledgeable of management issues. Boundary crossings is a very important area every nurse must be aware.

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40.

Answer is 1, 2, 4, and 5 are correct

1. A 2-lb weight gain indicates the client is retaining fluid and should contact the HCP. This is an appropriate teaching intervention.

2. Keeping the head of the bed elevated will help the client breathe easier; therefore, this is an appropriate teaching intervention.

4. Sodium retains water. Telling the client to avoid eating foods high in sodium is an appropriate teaching intervention.

5. Isotonic exercise, such as walking or swimming, helps tone the muscles, and discussing this with the client is an appropriate teaching intervention.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: This is an alternate type of question included in the NCLEX-RN®. The nurse must be able to select all the options that answer the question correctly. There are no partially correct answers.

41

Answer is 2. This potassium level is very low. Hypokalemia potentiates dysrhythmias in clients receiving digoxin. This nurse should discuss potassium replacement with the HCP before administering this medication.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker must know normal laboratory data.

42.

Answer is 3. The client's support system is the priority assessment for the hospice nurse. The client will be cared for in the home and the nurse must know who is available to help the client.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The test taker must be knowledgeable of all the various areas of nursing and the role of each member of the multidisciplinary healthcare team, as well as HIPAA rules and regulations. These topics will be tested on the NCLEX-RN® exam.

43

Answer is 2. The nurse should stay with the client and her husband and not make any lifesaving interventions while the client is dying. The husband should not be left alone

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: A do not resuscitate (DNR) is a written physician's order instructing healthcare providers not to attempt CPR. A new term recently introduced is "allow natural death" (AND). The nurse cannot legally perform CPR on a client who has a DNR.

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44.

Answer is 3. One of the main goals of hospice is pain and symptom control. This client should be seen first so that appropriate pain control can be obtained immediately

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: The nurse can use Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs to determine which client to assess first. Pain is a physiological need.

45

Answer is 1. Encouraging the client to review his or her life experiences assists the client to come to a closure of his or her life. This is an important intervention the volunteer can perform.

MAKING NURSING DECISIONS: When the test taker is deciding which option is the most appropriate task to delegate/assign, the test taker should choose the task that allows each staff member to function within his or her full scope of practice. Do not assign a task to a staff member that falls outside the staff member's or volunteer's expertise.

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